Yoorim Son

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Sogang University
M.A. Student in Economics
Seoul, Korea

yoorim0917@gmail.com
yoorims.github.io/yoorimson

Education

Sogang University, Seoul, Korea Mar 2025-present
M.A. in Economics; expected graduation: 2027
Advisor: Hyunjoo Yang
BK21 FOUR (Brain Korea 21), Participating Graduate Student Sep 2026-Feb 2027

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies Mar 2017-Feb 2021
B.A. in South African Languages and Cultures; Yongin, Korea
Minor in Political Science and Diplomacy

University of Botswana, Gaborone, Botswana Jan-May 2018
Visiting / Exchange Student

Research Interests

Development economics; applied microeconomics; digital infrastructure; spatial inequality; economic measurement.

Working Papers

Mobile Broadband Upgrading and Spatial Inequality in South Africa October 2026
(with Hyunjoo Yang).
Compares municipal broadband upgrading by initial quality, baseline poverty, and regulatory priority using quarterly Ookla data from South Africa's 2021-2024 spectrum transition.
Reduced low-speed disadvantage can coexist with widening absolute speed gaps.

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Hyunjoo Yang, Sogang University Apr 2026-present
Sogang Spatial Economics & AI Lab

Satellite-Based Global Crop Mapping and Yield-Prediction Design
Constructed maize and rice ground-truth datasets and completed rice sampling.
Develop XGBoost features to predict cultivated area across Asian countries.

North Korean Industrial Production and Economic Activity
Support a Bank of Korea collaboration on measuring North Korean industrial production and economic activity using daytime satellite imagery, atmospheric gas data, and AI.

Research Experience (continued)

Research Assistant to BooKang Seol (LSE) Nov 2025-present
MIRACLE: Subnational Economic Data for South Korea, 1960-1989
Project Leads: BooKang Seol, Changkeun Lee, and Hyunjoo Yang
Completed administrative-region data collection for a consistent township-year economic panel of South Korea, 1960-1989.
Extract and process historical statistical records using OCR.

Seminars & Conferences

2026 Korean Economic Review (KER) International Conference June 22, 2026
Halla Convention Center, Jeju, South Korea
The Economic Impact of Submarine Cable Arrival on Local Economic Activity: Evidence from South Africa (with Hyunjoo Yang).

Methods & Data

Programming: Python.
Empirical methods: Fixed effects, event studies, spatial exposure designs, synthetic-control diagnostics; training in difference-in-differences and instrumental variables.
Machine learning: XGBoost, sampling, and feature construction.
Data: Municipal and administrative panels; broadband measurements; GIS and satellite data; historical records and OCR; crop ground-truth datasets.

Languages

Korean: Native; English: Fluent.
Zulu, Setswana, Chinese, French, and German: Basic.